

PARKHURST TO SISTER
Nov 28, 1861.

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West Point Ky. Nov 28/61

My Dear Sister

This is a day appointed
for Thanksgiving in Mich & Ky.
I believe it is also your Thanks-
giving day - if so I hope you will
eat a good hearty dinner for
me & give thanks to God that
we are yet suffered to stay in
this world where we are
blessed with the luxuries of a
plentiful land - but my
dear Sister even it not for my
dear little ones under whose
happy smiles & cheerful ways you
can look but I cannot - I should

long to leave this sphere & go to
the pure world of angels &
listen to the chanting of
my own Angelia & know
that welcome which I know
He is waiting to give me
But my darling little ones,
my sister & my mother, what
would become of them - dear
little ones - I know they are
now protected & cared for with
the fondness of pure affection
but this cannot always be
I must live to care for them
to love them - O how a foretaste
of earthly love to them

and my mind tells me that
God will spare me for a guide
to them in the crooked ways
of this wicked world —

I am in excellent health, as
never before in my life — and
am growing fat & grip, for
my clothes feel uncomfortably
tight. But our Regiment is
in a bad shape. We have 320 on
the sick list — We have lost
16 by sickness since we have
been here and more are
very close. But the most of
them are improving —

I begin to think it very doubtful

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about leaving early to visit you
this winter. Genl. Bull has refused
several applications for leave on
account of sickness & I am well. I
fear he will not grant me leave. The
Col. can grant me leave of 7. days, but
that would only allow me to go & return
without making a visit - but I
shall try to get away & see you &
my little ones if for only "a day"

I enclose ten dollars worth which
I send you purpose for Kettie
or you as fit - If you should not
hear from me again before then
please buy her some Christmas
present - I want to hear from

you as often as possible - Keep me
aboard Kettie till her I think of
her every day - I want to see her so
bad that I almost cry to think I can't

Effectually Yours Bro

John